

Ecuador



Ecuador straddles the equator. The country also includes the Galápagos Islands in the Pacific.

1478 The area of present-day Ecuador is incorporated into the Inca Empire by Topa Yupanqui. Centered around Quito, the region rapidly develops into an important commercial center.

c.1527 On the death of Inca Huayna Capac, the Inca Empire is divided in two between Huáscar in Cuzco and his younger brother Atahualpa, who is based in Quito. Atahualpa defeats Huáscar in 1532 in a battle outside Cuzco to become sole ruler, only to be captured by Pizarro later that year. The war of succession fatally weakens the Inca Empire, which falls to the Spanish invaders.

1528 Francisco Pizarro sails along the coast as far as the border of present-day Ecuador and Peru.

1533 Sebastián de Benalcázar, one of Pizarro's lieutenants, leads expedition to the region, which is claimed for Spain.

1563 The Audiencia of Quito is established within the Viceroyalty of Peru. It is transferred to the jurisdiction of the Viceroyalty of New Granada in 1739.

1809 An abortive rebellion fails.

1822 Quito is taken from the Spanish by Antonio José de Sucre at the Battle of Pichincha. Simón Bolívar incorporates Ecuador into Gran Colombia, along with Colombia, Panama, and Venezuela.

1830 Gran Colombia dissolves, and Ecuador becomes an independent state under Juan José Flores, a Conservative.

1832 Ecuador tries but fails to win Popayán province from Colombia; annexes Galápagos Islands.

1850s The Conservatives, who support the Catholic church, and the radical Liberals, who support economic reform, begin lengthy battle for power.

1925 The army replaces the coastal banking interests as the ultimate source of power in the country.

1941–42 Loss of mineral-rich El Oro region to Peru.

1944–47 José María Velasco Ibarra stages a coup and becomes president for the second time.

1948 Reforming president Galo Plaza Lasso wins in free elections and introduces wide-ranging political reforms.

1948–60 Ecuador develops its banana plantations.

1952 Velasco Ibarra returns to power. He improves schools and roads.

1955–60 Camilo Ponce Enríquez is first Conservative president in 60 years.

1960 The government renounces peace treaty that gave El Oro region to Peru.

1963–66 Military junta rules.

1968 Velasco Ibarra is elected president for the fifth time. Faced with dissent, he takes absolute power in 1970.

1972 Oil production starts. Velasco Ibarra is ousted in a military coup.

1979 Return to democracy as the military end their rule.

1992 Amerindians win land in Amazonia.

1997 President Abdala Bucaram deposed by Congress after his administration seeks to implement popular reforms.

1998–99 Jamil Mahuad of the Popular Democratic Party wins elections.

2000 After massive depreciation of the sucre, it is replaced by the US dollar.

2000 Army sides with Amerindian protestors. Vice president Gustavo Noboa replaces Mahuad.

2002 Lucio Gutiérrez, leader of the 2000 coup, is elected president.

2005 Gutiérrez is removed by Congress; elections in 2006 won by Rafael Correa.

2007 In a referendum, voters approve a new constituent assembly.

2008 Ecuador announces it will default on billions of dollars of debt.

2009 President Correa wins second term.

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Banana republic

Ecuador is the world's biggest producer of bananas and supports a major fishing industry. The country is also a net exporter of oil obtained from Amazonia, east of the Andes.

Peru



Once the heart of the Inca Empire, Peru has a large indigenous population of Quechua speakers.

c.1000–200 BCE Chavin civilization flourishes. It is followed by the Nazca, c.200 BCE–800 CE, who first develop large-scale irrigation systems.

1300s CE Under the reign of the fourth emperor, Mayta Capac, the Inca begin to attack their neighbors and extend their power beyond their base in the Cuzco valley. By the 15th century, the Inca Empire reaches as far as present-day central Chile, and the Inca language, Quechua, has been imposed on all its subjects.

Inca gold

This figure is typical of Inca craftsmanship. The Spanish melted down many such objects found in the Inca capital, Cuzco, for shipment to Spain.



1528 Francisco Pizarro sails along the coast as far as the frontier of present-day Peru and Ecuador.

1532 Pizarro lands and captures the Inca ruler Atahualpa. The Incas are massacred at Cajamarca. Atahualpa is executed in 1533. The invaders advance to the capital, Cuzco, and strip it of gold.

1542 Viceroyalty of Peru is established.

1780–81 Tupac Amaru II leads an unsuccessful revolt against Spanish rule.

1821 Independence is proclaimed in Lima after its capture by Argentine liberator José de San Martín, who has just liberated Chile from Spanish rule.

1824 Spain suffers final defeats at battles of Junín and Ayacucho by Simón Bolívar and Antonio José de Sucre, liberators of Venezuela and Colombia. Peru now gains full independence.

1836–39 Peru and Bolivia join in a short-lived confederation, ended when Chile intervenes, fearing that the new state is a threat to its interests.

1844–51 General Ramón Castilla is president; he returns to power in 1855–62. Under his rule, Peru enjoys stability and economic development: the guano and nitrate deposits are exploited for the first time, and transportation links are improved.

1860 New constitution introduced that remains in force until 1920.

1866 Peruvian–Spanish War as Spain attempts to regain Peru.

1872–76 Manuel Pardo is the first democratically elected president.

1879–84 War of the Pacific: Chile defeats Peru and Bolivia. Peru loses territory in south.

1908–12 Augusto Leguía y Salcedo rules as a dictator. He comes to power again in 1919 and rules until 1930.

1911 The lost Inca city Machu Picchu is discovered by Hiram Bingham.

1924 Dr. Víctor Raúl Haya de la Torre founds nationalist and radical American Popular Revolutionary Alliance (APRA) in exile in Mexico.

1930 Leguía is ousted: APRA moves home to Peru as first political party.

1931–45 APRA is banned.

1939–45 A moderate, pro-US civilian government comes to power.

1948 General Manuel Odría takes power and APRA is banned again.

1956 Civilian government is restored.

1962, 1963 Two military coups.

1963 Election of Fernando Belaúnde Terry, a moderate reformer. Land reform begins to redistribute land to poor peasant farmers, but the military is used to suppress a communist-inspired insurgency.

1968 A left-wing military junta takes over. It attempts to alleviate poverty and adopts a policy of widespread nationalization.

1975–78 New right-wing military junta runs the country.

1980 Belaúnde reelected. The Maoist guerrilla group Sendero Luminoso (Shining Path) begins an armed struggle.

1981–98 Border war with Ecuador over the El Oro region, the Amazonian territory given to Peru by a 1942 treaty.

1982 Deaths and "disappearances" start to escalate as the army cracks down on guerrillas and the drug trade.

1985 First-ever electoral win for APRA, under Alán García Pérez.

1987 Peru goes bankrupt as García's government fails; plans to nationalize banks are blocked by the new Libertad movement led by novelist Mario Vargas Llosa.

1990 Over 3,000 political murders a year as violence engulfs the country. Alberto Fujimori, an independent, is elected president on an anticorruption platform and introduces austerity program.

1992 Fujimori's "self-coup": Fujimori summarily closes Congress. A referendum